

STAGE FIFTEEN • BUSINESS & ORGANIZATIONAL ACUMEN

FIRSTS

SESSION PLAN

Three sessions, mapped and timed, to run all 25 FIRSTS as a live workshop

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Session Plan

Stage Fifteen • Business & Organizational Acumen

OVERVIEW

Stage Fifteen's twenty-five FIRSTS split across three sessions, matching the Manual's existing structure: Understanding How Organizations Work, Analyzing the Business, and Strategic & Reflective Business Thinking. The section sizes are genuinely uneven (nine, ten, and six FIRSTS) — Session 3 covers fewer, more advanced exercises, each of which needs real room rather than being rushed to match the pacing of the other two sessions.

This stage works best when participants can reference a real organization — a current job, internship, or a family member's business if needed. Purely hypothetical work through this stage is possible but noticeably less useful; encourage real context wherever it exists.

AT A GLANCE

Time	Segment	Format
Session 1	Understanding How Organizations Work — S1-S9	~100 min
Session 2	Analyzing the Business — S10-S19	~125 min
Session 3	Strategic & Reflective Business Thinking — S20-S25	~100 min

SESSION 1

Understanding How Organizations Work

Covers FIRSTS S1-S9: Business Model Awareness, Organizational Structure Awareness, Department Function Mapping, Revenue Model Awareness, Cost Structure Awareness, Budget Awareness, Profit & Loss Awareness, Business KPI Awareness, Operational Metrics Exercise.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to think of one organization they can reference throughout this session — a current job, internship, or, if neither applies, a company they know reasonably well from the outside.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00-0:10	Welcome + framing: business acumen means understanding the organization you're actually in, not abstract theory	Full group
0:10-0:30	FIRST S1 — Business Model Awareness: draft a 3-sentence explanation	Solo
0:30-0:45	FIRST S2 — Organizational Structure Awareness: map departments and reporting lines	Solo
0:45-1:00	FIRST S3 — Department Function Mapping: plan a real conversation	Solo
1:00-1:05	Short break	—

1:05-1:20	FIRSTS S4-S5 — Revenue Model + Cost Structure Awareness	Solo
1:20-1:30	FIRST S6 — Budget Awareness	Solo
1:30-1:50	FIRST S7 — Profit & Loss Awareness: read a sample or real P&L	Solo
1:50-2:05	FIRSTS S8-S9 — Business KPI Awareness + Operational Metrics + close	Solo

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST S3 genuinely can't be completed live — it requires a real conversation with someone in another department. Frame it as launched today, followed up on independently.
- For participants without current access to a real organization's P&L (FIRST S7), have a sample, anonymized P&L ready as a backup so the exercise still works.
- This session is dense with awareness-building FIRSTS; keep pace brisk on S1-S6 to leave real room for S7, which benefits from more time.

SESSION 2

Analyzing the Business

Covers FIRSTS S10–S19: Stakeholder Mapping Exercise, Customer Journey Mapping, Process Mapping Exercise, Business Problem Analysis, Business Case Created, Cost-Benefit Analysis, Business Recommendation, Market Research Exercise, Competitive Analysis, Industry Analysis.

PRE-WORK

- Ask participants to identify one real business problem, initiative, or decision at their organization they could analyze throughout this session — the more real and current, the more useful this session becomes.
- Bring a laptop; several exercises this session involve real research.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: today moves from understanding the organization to genuinely analyzing it	Full group
0:10–0:30	FIRST S10 — Stakeholder Mapping Exercise	Solo
0:30–0:50	FIRST S11 — Customer Journey Mapping	Solo
0:50–1:10	FIRST S12 — Process Mapping Exercise	Solo
1:10–1:15	Short break	—
1:15–1:35	FIRST S13 — Business Problem Analysis: work toward a genuine root cause	Solo
1:35–2:00	FIRST S14 — Business Case Created: build a full case	Solo, give real room
2:00–2:20	FIRSTS S15–S16 — Cost-Benefit Analysis + Business Recommendation	Solo
2:20–2:45	FIRSTS S17–S19 — Market Research + Competitive Analysis + Industry Analysis + close	Solo, laptops needed

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST S14 (Business Case Created) is the most demanding single exercise in this stage — do not compress it to fit a strict time box; let it run long if participants are genuinely engaged, and trim later, lower-stakes FIRSTS instead.
- S17–S19 are research-heavy and can compress into a single connected research block if time is tight, since they build on each other (market → competitors → industry).
- This is the longest session in the stage; consider a second short break if energy flags in the back half.

SESSION 3

Strategic & Reflective Business Thinking

Covers FIRSTS S20–S25: Strategic Objective Analysis, Executive Perspective Exercise, Organizational Decision Analysis, Business Process Improvement, Organizational Change Awareness, Business Acumen Reflection.

PRE-WORK

- This is the final session of the stage; let participants know they'll close with a full-stage reflection, not just a session-level one.
- Ask participants to bring to mind one process inefficiency they've noticed at their organization, for use in FIRST S23.

SESSION AGENDA

Time	Segment	Format
0:00–0:10	Welcome + framing: today is about synthesis — pulling everything from Sessions 1 and 2 into genuine strategic thinking	Full group
0:10–0:30	FIRST S20 — Strategic Objective Analysis: map activities against goals	Solo
0:30–0:50	FIRST S21 — Executive Perspective Exercise	Solo
0:50–1:10	FIRST S22 — Organizational Decision Analysis	Solo
1:10–1:15	Short break	—
1:15–1:35	FIRST S23 — Business Process Improvement: propose a real fix	Solo
1:35–1:50	FIRST S24 — Organizational Change Awareness	Solo
1:50–2:10	FIRST S25 — Business Acumen Reflection + full-stage close	Solo, then full-group share

FACILITATOR NOTES

- FIRST S23 (Business Process Improvement) explicitly requires real follow-through after the session — the in-session work is proposing the fix, not necessarily implementing it. Be clear about this distinction.
- FIRST S25 is a full-stage reflection, not just a Session 3 wrap-up — explicitly ask participants to look back across all three sections.
- Close by having each participant name their single strongest area of business acumen and their single most significant remaining gap, out loud or in a shared doc.